

Dear Parent/Guardian,

RE: FOUNDATION PHASE AND INTERSEN PHASE AWARDS CEREMONY – INFORMATION FOR PARENTS

As we approach the end of the academic year, we look forward to celebrating the achievements, growth and dedication of our learners during our annual Awards Ceremonies. In the interest of transparency and fairness, we would like to outline the criteria used for awards in both the Foundation Phase and the Intersen Phase. These guidelines ensure that all awards are granted based on clear, measurable and consistent standards across the school.

FOUNDATION PHASE AWARDS CEREMONY

In the Foundation Phase, awards focus strictly on academic achievement, as this stage lays the core foundation for future learning. We recognise consistent effort, growth and mastery of age-appropriate skills.

1. Academic Awards – Top 5 Academic Achievers per Class

Learners are assessed primarily through rubrics and achievement levels rather than percentages. The selection of the Top 5 is based on:

- CAPS Achievement Levels (1–7): including reading, writing, numeracy, thinking skills, and oral language
- Overall Year Performance: consistent achievement across all four terms
- Progress and Improvement: steady growth in achievement levels or rubric scores
- Bookwork and Homework Quality: neatness, accuracy, responsibility, and completion of work
- Classwork and Participation: engagement, effort, behaviour, and willingness to learn

These criteria provide a holistic and fair evaluation of each learner's academic performance.

2. Subject Achievement Awards

Each class will have one top achiever per subject. Awards are based on:

- Highest and most consistent achievement levels
- Accurate completion of assessments and tasks
- Application of skills taught
- Demonstrated independence and understanding of subject concepts

3. Reading Awards

Reading remains a core focus in the Foundation Phase. Awards are based on:

- Reading level progression
- Number of levelled readers or library books completed
- Reading assessments, including comprehension and fluency
- Participation and improvement in the Reading Buddies Programme

Learners showing excellence, improvement, or outstanding dedication will be acknowledged.

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4. Important Note Regarding Certificates

In previous years, certificates were issued to all learners at this event. However, according to current policy requirements, the Foundation Phase Awards Ceremony must focus only on academic awards.

- All other recognition certificates will be handed out during assemblies.
- From 2026, Culture and Sport awards will be introduced for the Foundation Phase, along with additional amended categories.

INTERSEN PHASE AWARDS CEREMONY

The Intersen Phase Awards acknowledge excellence in Academics, Culture, Sport, Merit, Ambassadorship, Leadership and personal improvement.

Please Note:

All floating trophies will be handed to learners for photographs only and must be returned to Mrs Mandigo on the same night.

All participation certificates were handed out throughout the term in assemblies. Learners will not be receiving participation certificates on the awards ceremony.

1. Culture Awards

These awards recognise learners who have demonstrated outstanding participation, talent and commitment in cultural activities.

Criteria include:

- Consistent involvement in choir, drama, public speaking, dance, or productions
- Dedication to practices and performances
- Notable excellence, leadership, or improvement

Awards: Certificate, medal, take-home trophy, floating trophy (for photos only)

2. Merit Awards

Based on the school's merit and demerit system.

Criteria:

- Highest number of merits per grade
- Consistent positive behaviour and attitude

Awards: Certificate; the learner with the most merits receives a Merit Badge

3. Ambassador Awards

Recognising learners who uphold the school's values.

Criteria:

- Consistent exemplary behaviour
- Following school rules
- No demerits
- Positive role modelling

Awards: Certificate and an Ambassador Badge

4. Sport Awards

Recognising excellence, improvement, leadership, and sportsmanship.

Categories:

- Overall Sports Boy & Overall Sports Girl
- Netball Player of the Year
- Athlete of the Year
- Soccer/Football Player of the Year (Boy & Girl)

Measured Through:

- Performance in matches, events, and tournaments
- Commitment to training and practices
- Coach evaluations
- Improvement, teamwork, attitude, and school representation

Awards: Certificate, medal, take-home trophy, floating trophy (for photos only). Overall winners also receive a Sport Badge

5. Academic Awards

a) Subject Achievement

Learners must meet the following thresholds:

- All subjects: 75% and above
- Life Skills (Gr 4–6): 80% and above
- Life Orientation & Creative Arts (Gr 7): 80% and above

Each subject receives a Top Achiever Award.

b) Overall Academic Top Achiever per Grade

Awarded to the learner with the highest overall year average.

c) Most Improved Learner

Recognises the learner who has shown the greatest improvement across the year.

d) Academic Badge

Learners achieving an overall average of 80% or above receive an Academic Badge.

Awards for all Academic categories:

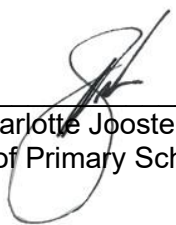
Certificate, medal, take-home trophy, floating trophy (to be returned the same night)

Closing Note

We are proud of all our learners and their achievements throughout the year. These awards celebrate not only excellence but also effort, dedication, and growth.

We thank you for your continued support and look forward to celebrating the successes of our learners together. For anything that is not clear, please contact the phase heads.

Kind regards,



Ms Charlotte Jooste
Head of Primary School